TradeLink

Food Wholesale Marketplace
Business & Technical MVP Plan

Initial operating market: Malka Jabdu, Ethiopia

1. Executive summary

TradeLink is a centrally operated digital wholesale marketplace connecting imported-food goods owners, authorized agents and wholesale buyers. Agents submit product listings; the platform owner reviews and approves them; customers browse without mandatory registration, contact agents directly to negotiate, and arrange collection from one central warehouse using their own transport.

2. Confirmed decisions

Decision	Confirmed model
Project name	TradeLink
Ownership	Single owner / centrally controlled platform
Initial category	Food products only; other categories may be added later
Languages	English, Somali and Amharic
Warehouse	One central warehouse
Commission payer	Importer / goods owner pays TradeLink
Pricing	Negotiable; customer and agent agree directly
Customer access	Public browsing; no mandatory customer account
Collection	Customer arranges own vehicle and collects at warehouse
Payments	No online payment in the initial MVP

3. How the business works

• Goods owner / importer authorizes agents and confirms the products and stock they may represent.

• Agent submits product name, category, description, unit, quantity, photos and contact details.

• Administrator verifies the submission and approves or rejects it before public display.

• Customer browses listings and contacts the agent by WhatsApp, Telegram or phone.

• Customer and agent negotiate price, quantity and collection timing directly.

• If agreed, the reservation/order is recorded in TradeLink and stock is reserved by authorized staff.

• Customer arranges transport and collects at the central warehouse; warehouse staff record collection.

• TradeLink records the qualifying sale and calculates the commission payable by the importer / goods owner.

4. MVP modules

Module	Core responsibility
Public marketplace	Browse approved food listings, search, filter and contact agent.
Agent workspace	Submit/edit own listings, see approval state and inquiries.
Admin workspace	Manage agents, approve listings, review inquiries and monitor activity.
Warehouse inventory	One stock ledger; receipts, reservations, releases, collections and adjustments.
Reservations & orders	Track inquiry, negotiation, reservation, confirmation and collection.
Commission reports	Record agreed commission terms, qualifying sales, amounts due and settlement status.
Localization	English, Somali and Amharic interface labels and key user flows.

5. Roles and permissions

• Owner / administrator: full platform configuration, agent access, listing approval, inventory oversight, order oversight, commission rules and reports.

• Agent: submit and manage own listings, view own inquiries and negotiation status; cannot approve own listings or alter warehouse stock independently.

• Warehouse staff: record authorized stock movements, reservations and collections; no access to commission settings.

• Public customer: browse approved listings and contact agents; no account required for browsing.

6. Technical architecture

Frontend: React + TypeScript + Vite, responsive for desktop and mobile. Backend/data: Supabase Postgres and Auth. Hosting: Vercel. The starter ZIP includes a public marketplace UI, sample food listings, Supabase client placeholder and initial SQL tables for agents, products, stock movements and inquiries. Production access must use role-based authorization, server-side validation and restrictive Row Level Security policies.

7. Core data records

Agents; products; product photos; warehouse stock movements; inquiries; reservations; orders; order status history; commission agreements; commission ledger; users and role assignments; audit events. Stock should be derived from auditable movements or updated only through trusted database functions, not arbitrary client-side edits.

8. Commission policy to finalize

Before launch, sign an agreement with each importer / goods owner specifying the commission rate or fixed fee, the exact event that makes commission payable (for example, completed collection), treatment of

cancellations/returns, evidence required, payment due date, reconciliation method and dispute process. The platform should not silently assume a commission percentage.

9. Operational controls and risks

• Written authorization: verify that each agent may advertise, negotiate and reserve the listed goods.

• Stock accuracy: appoint one accountable warehouse stock controller and perform scheduled physical reconciliation.

• Food information: verify product identity, origin where relevant, packaging, grade, expiry/best-before information and required local compliance details.

• Disputes: define escalation for short quantity, damaged goods, price disagreements, cancellations and commission disputes.

• Privacy/security: collect only necessary customer details, restrict staff access by role, log sensitive actions and set retention rules.

• No false service claims: TradeLink is not a delivery company, transport provider, customs broker or online payment processor in this MVP.

10. Implementation sequence

• Foundation: repository, Vercel deployment, Supabase project, environment variables and database migrations.

• Identity & access: admin and agent authentication, role model, secure session handling and tested RLS policies.

• Listings: agent submission, image upload, admin review and public approved-only catalogue.

• Warehouse: opening balances, receipts, reservations, releases, collection and reconciliation.

• Commercial workflow: inquiries, negotiation notes, reservation/order status and commission ledger.

• Localization & launch: professionally review English, Somali and Amharic translations; test mobile usability; train staff; pilot with a limited set of verified agents and products.

11. Launch acceptance checklist

■ Only approved listings are visible publicly.

■ Agents cannot approve their own listings or edit another agent’s private records.

■ Only authorized warehouse roles can post stock movements.

■ Every stock change has a user, timestamp, quantity and reference.

■ Reservations cannot exceed available stock.

■ Collection closes the order and triggers the agreed commission calculation.

■ Commission reports reconcile with completed orders and signed agreements.

■ All three languages are reviewed; phone and desktop layouts work.

■ Backups, access recovery, audit logs and dispute procedures are tested.

Document status: MVP blueprint and starter-code scope. This is a planning document, not legal, tax or food-safety advice. Confirm applicable Ethiopian requirements with qualified local advisers before commercial

launch.